Bachelor of Arts in English Language Studies

Thesis Companion



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Foreword

Writing your own thesis is a very daunting task. It is one of the most intellectually demanding and transformative experiences in undergraduate education. It requires students to move beyond consuming knowledge and toward producing it — by asking meaningful questions, engaging critically with existing scholarship, and presenting well-argued, ethical, and original research. For many, thesis writing and its process can also feel overwhelming, confusing, and isolating.

This Thesis Companion was developed to support students throughout the research and writing journey. It is designed to serve as a practical, accessible, and discipline-sensitive reference that accompanies students from the early stages of topic selection to the final submission and oral defense.

Ultimately, this Research Companion seeks to remind students that while thesis writing is challenging, it is also an opportunity to contribute a small but meaningful voice to academic conversations, to sharpen analytical and writing skills, and to experience the discipline as a community of inquiry. With guidance, persistence, and thoughtful engagement, the thesis can become not merely a requirement to complete but a culminating learning experience to value.

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Chapter 1. The thesis process at a glance

This chapter provides an overview of the entire thesis journey. It presents key stages, timelines, and common milestones to help students see the process as manageable and structured. The chapter also addresses common misconceptions and emotional challenges faced by previous BAELS students who successfully accomplished their thesis requirement.

Timeline

When a BAELS student reaches the junior level, they are expected to think about their research interests. This will become handy once they are enrolled to ELS 199 during the second semester. The timeline of thesis writing, from its inception to final defense, is presented in the table below:

Month	Task	Expected Output
2nd Semester		
January	Orientation to thesis requirements and policies; topic exploration and consultation	Topic inception and literature scoping narrowing and refining the topic
February	Assignment to thesis adviser**; Adviser endorsement	Must have possible research topics with preliminary literature review
March	Writing the thesis proposal	Expanded and systematic literature review
April	Refining the proposal; creating visual presentation	Submit the adviser-approved thesis proposal
May	Thesis Proposal Defense*	Successful oral presentation of the proposal
Midyear		
June	Ethics clearance application (if required)/ Data collection	Submit to RIET for approval Organized and completed data collection
July	Data analysis	Submit initial data analysis to adviser for confirmation
1st Semester		
August	Drafting Section 3 (Results, Analysis, and Discussion)	
September	Writing Section 4 (Conclusions and Recommendations)	Submit for adviser feedback and revisions
October	Finalizing the manuscript; Creating visual presentation	Integration of all chapters; formatting and consistency checks; submit adviser-approved thesis manuscript
November	Final Oral Defense*	Successful oral defense
December	Incorporating panel comments and suggestions	Submit to adviser for feedback

*Note. *A student may be subjected to ONE redefense only; **regular adviser consultation is strongly recommended.*

Revisions on every section/part of the thesis are part of the process. Every holiday, class postponement, and weekends must be dedicated in writing the thesis. Any delays or postponement on the writing schedule will also entail shorter time in finalizing the manuscript. Do not hesitate to consult the assigned thesis adviser. Treat them as another set of eyes and brains that will evaluate the quality of the thesis.

Common Myths and Misconceptions

Below are some myths and misconceptions about thesis writing:

1. My topic should be original.

   No. As an undergraduate student, your task is confirming what theories and previous scholars have already investigated. Originality means applying existing theories to new data, contexts, and perspectives.

2. The more literature I include, the better.

   No. The literature review part of your thesis is not a mere collection of scholarly work. The more you have means the topic is oversaturated and many scholars have already addressed various gaps. The literature review grounds your own investigation and shows that there are some research gaps about the topic at hand. Literature review may be systematic, historic, or thematically arranged.

3. I can only write when I am motivated.

   No. Remember that writing is input-based. You cannot write anything if you did not read anything. Reading related journal articles will greatly help ONLY if you organize them in a way that you understand them the most. Try to use Microsoft Excel or Google Numbers to organize your literature. This way, you do not need to return to your journal articles every now and then.

4. I need a perfect draft.

   No. There is no such thing as a perfect draft. From your thesis title down to recommendations, these will constantly change as you progress. Treat revisions as redirections for a clearer direction of your thesis.

Emotional Challenges faced by thesis writers

As you go through thesis writing, it is inevitable to feel lost. This is normal. Look at what your seniors revealed when they were writing their own thesis.



Chapter 2. The Thesis Proposal

In this chapter, the process of selecting your thesis topic down to proposal presentation is discussed. Remember that writing is not a linear process – it is a case-to-case basis.

Choosing a thesis topic

The subject or topic chosen for the student's thesis should be feasible considering the given time. Think and write language topics that are interesting to you. It may be from previous journal articles that you encountered, courses where you had research projects, or an issue you have observed from the local Philippine context. Identifying a research topic is not always about agreeing with the results, you may also disagree with a research and challenge what has been known to many. In narrowing down your topic, think about these two questions: *(i) what do you want to learn more about? and (ii)what do scholars already know?* ((Barakso, 2013).

A good place to start narrowing down your topic is by engaging with various scholarly sources – books, journal articles, and webinars. Take note of what has been done, the argument of the reference you are reading, the methodology applied, and what are the results. If recommendations are provided, list them down. Organization is key in doing this so that it is easier to identify the research gap of the topic you have chosen.

Common ELS research tracks

The English language is very flexible that it can be studied alone or anchored with another area of interest. A study may focus on the categories of language (i.e. morphology, syntax, semantics, phonology, pragmatics), or interdisciplinary (e.g. language and gender, language and media, language and society, language and environment, language and law, etc.). However, always remember that thesis writing for BAELS students are bound by time – so think of a topic that you can finish for one year and factor in key issues that you may encounter.

Categories of Language/Focus on Linguistics

Under this track, you can choose topics under one or two categories of language, but keep in mind that you should be able to finish your thesis on time. Below are some of the titles of previous batches that focused solely on language:

BALUYUT, ERICSON D.	Examining Gender Representation in Grade Six English Instructional Materials
CARREON, PRECIOUS MARIE M.	Linguistic Analysis of the English Wedding Hashtags on Facebook
CASTRO, MARCHELLE	r/Philippines: Linguistic Analysis of Reddit Post Titles
CHAN, KYLE MARIE	Paradigmatic Analysis of Linguistic Complexity in English Language News in the Philippines
DATU, LORNA	Morpho-Semantic Analysis of Neologisms in TikTok
GALANG, MEDWIN ANDREI P.	A Lexico-Semantic Analysis of 21st Century Multilingual Philippine Pop Songs
GOMEZ, MICAH NICOLE	The use of Euphemisms in Philippine Online Obituaries
AGUINALDO, RASHEED KEN C.	Uncovering Linguistic Features and Patterns in Social Discrimination: Analysis of Facebook Comments on News Articles about Filipina Transgender Women
GONZALES, JEANNA MAEZEL S.	Queerdom: A Comparative Morphological Analysis of Modern Gaylingo and Early Gaylingo
PARAS, ALANNE HEART	Type Kita: A Linguistic Analysis of Tumblr's Love Letters
NABONG, PATRICE A	It's Like, Ano Po: A Comparison of Filipino and English Discourse Markers in Philippine Talk Shows
RAZON , JACQUELYN C	Intentional Grammatical Inaccuracies in English Usage within JOIRA's Facebook Vlogs

Interdisciplinary Research

Interdisciplinary research in the BAELS program recognizes that language does not only exist in isolation but is deeply connected to social, cultural, political, technological, and psychological contexts. Such research is not only about the sole study of language, but also the application of theories, methods, and perspectives from multiple disciplines.

Interdisciplinary BAELS thesis may be drawn from fields such as agriculture, sociology, psychology, anthropology, media studies, gender studies, law and politics, education, communication, and digital studies among others. Through interdisciplinary research, BAELS students are encouraged to examine real-world linguistic phenomena using appropriate linguistic frameworks (e.g. discourse analysis, content analysis, sociolinguistics, etc.).

Selected sample thesis titles of BAELS graduates are listed on the next page:

Cabuso, Dannalyn N.	Sustainable Fragrance: Multimodal Ecolinguistics Analysis of "Cruelty-Free" Scents Online Advertisements
Domingo, Gloomy Rain	Audiovisual Translation of Culture-based Humor: An Analysis of PGAG's English Subtitles
Ferreras, Erica A.	Parents' Attitude and Practices in Gender-Inclusive Language
Pablo, Trisha Kaye	Drink Responsibly: A Multimodal Analysis of the Language of Filipino Alcohol Advertisements
Palima, Pea Luisa P.	Language, Food, and Filipino Cultural Identities: Multimodal Analysis of Jollibee Short Film Advertisements
Alberca, Rhegen G.	Gender Ideologies in Household Product Advertisements: A Multimodal Analysis
Padilla , Cristian M.	Reading the Streets : A Study of Linguistics Landscape in Multicultural communication
Paras, Daniella Joy P.	Ecological Discourse Analysis of Plastic Bottled Drink Advertisements
Pugal, Juan Carlos G.	Critical Discourse Analysis of Sexist Ideologies in Primary Education English Language Textbooks in the Philippines
Viernes, Alysa S.	Language Vitality and Endangerment: Sociolinguistic Perspectives on Kapampangan in English Influence
Dullas, Zylri C	Gender Representation vis-à-vis Body Fragmentation of Men and Women in Philippine Wattpad Adult Fiction
Ortiz, Keziah L	AI-Written Vs. Human Written Texts In Student Commentaries: A Comparative Analysis
Supan, Clarence Nicole S	The Persuasive Power of Visual and Textual Strategies in Online Casino Advertisements: A multimodal Analysis of Facebook Advertisement in The Philippines

The Thesis Adviser

The thesis adviser will be given during ELS 199 via two ways: based on specialization or research interest of the faculty member or randomly assigned. If the research proposal of a BAELS student aligns with a specific faculty member, then, they may be assigned to that faculty member. However, since not all faculty members are familiar with some ELS topics, they may be assigned randomly to a faculty member using wheel of names.

Composition of the Thesis Committee

Each thesis shall be examined by a panel consisting of three to four members, including the adviser and the department chair/research coordinator. The Thesis Committee shall be composed of two faculty members from the Department of English, the Department Chair and/or the BAELS Research Coordinator, and the thesis adviser. In cases involving interdisciplinary research, an external panelist may be invited to serve as one of the committee members. Panel members may be excused from attendance only

once and shall be required to submit a written manuscript review during the thesis proposal stage.

The Proposal Process

Before the Thesis Proposal

a. A student must submit three plausible topics (supported by literature review and target methodology) to the ELS 199 instructor. Title approvals are on first-come, first-serve basis. A duplicate study will be automatically rejected when another student has been approved beforehand.
b. A topic/title presentation may be scheduled upon the agreement of the faculty members as a precedent to proposal defense.*
c. Once the title is approved, the student must complete the thesis proposal including the suggestions of the adviser and faculty members during the title presentations.
d. A student ready for proposal defense must submit an accomplished Oral Presentation Form to the program research coordinator. The student must prepare printed copies (one print per member and adviser) of their approved manuscript and submits them to the research coordinator for distribution.
e. The schedule of presentations shall be prepared by the research coordinator and will be distributed to the students. However, the schedule is subject to change upon the availability of the panel members. In cases of adjustments, the students, adviser, and panel members will be informed by the research coordinator and is responsible in informing the rescheduled date of presentation. Meanwhile, the student must print the individual comments form and appoint a classmate that will serve as secretary during the oral presentation.

During the Thesis Proposal

a. The student is expected to prepare an audio-visual presentation of their study. The presentation includes:
    a. Rationale of the study
    b. The research gap
    c. The research questions
    d. Research framework
    e. Research Participants/Corpus of the Study
b. The total time allotted for each presentation is 1.5 hours only, where 30 minutes is allotted to the presentation, and the remaining time is for the question and

answer. The secretary is responsible in taking notes of the comments and suggestions of the thesis committee. They must secure the signatures of the thesis committee members after the oral presentation before submitting the forms to the research coordinator for filing.

c. The Thesis Adviser may postpone the scheduled thesis proposal defense even after the manuscript has been submitted. In such cases, the student shall be given ten (10) calendar days to address and comply with the Adviser's comments. The proposal defense may be rescheduled upon the Adviser's confirmation that the required revisions have been satisfactorily completed.
d. In case of a natural disaster, suspension of classes, power interruption, or other extraordinary situations that requires people to stay at home, a reschedule may be considered either face-to-face or online via Zoom.
e. After the oral presentation, the thesis committee shall conduct a closed-door deliberation to decide on the thesis outcome. Once a decision is reached, the result will be announced to the student by their thesis adviser.
f. If the student fails to accomplish the thesis proposal after the resubmission, they will receive a grade of 5.0 in ELS 199/LR 1.

After the Thesis Proposal

a. The student and their secretary must submit the signed individual comments form to the BAELS research coordinator for filing. The student must secure a copy of the approved comments form before submission.
b. The student must also secure signatures of the thesis committee for the Post-Defense Approval Sheet (PDAS). The form officially allows the student to collect data or secure an ethics clearance from the RIET office before administering surveys or interviews to human participants.

Chapter 3. Technical Guidelines

This chapter contains the technical guidelines on the proper format of the BAELS thesis as approved by the faculty members from the Department and by the PSAU Board of Regents.

a. Paper setting – A4
b. Margins – Left: 1.5"; Right, Top, and Bottom: 1.00"
c. Font style: Georgia
d. Font sizes (see table 1)
e. Pagination – upper right corner; same font style and size of body

Table 1

Style descriptions

Description	Example
HEADING *Centered, all caps, size 14*	**INTRODUCTION** **METHODOLOGY** **RESULTS, ANALYSIS, AND DISCUSSION** **CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**
Sub-Heading 1 *Right alignment, sentence case, bold, size 12*	**Background of the Study** **Statement of the Problem** **Research Context** **Profile of the Respondents** **Conclusions**
Sub-Heading 2 Right alignment, sentence case, italics, size 12	*Literature Review Topics*
Sub-Heading 3 Indented first line, terminology in bold, (and/or period) after the term.	**[Significance of the Study]** **ELS Practitioners.** The significant benefit to this group must be explained. **[Definition of Terms]** **Terminology** may be defined conceptually and/or conceptually.

Description	Example
Body/Content Justified and indented, size 11	The body/content of the thesis must be justified throughout the document. Indentions must be observed.

A sample outline of the thesis follows this chapter.

No page number for the title page.

YOUR TITLE MUST BE WRITTEN IN ALL CAPS, SIZE 14, BOLD FACE, AND PLACED AT THE CENTER. IF THE TITLE IS LONG, FORMAT IT IN AN INVERTED TRIANGLE

A Thesis [Proposal]
Presented to the Faculty
of Department of English
College of Arts and Sciences
Pampanga State Agricultural University
Magalang, Pampanga

The word "Proposal" must be removed when presenting the results of the study during the final defense.

In Partial Fulfillment
of the Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF ARTS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE STUDIES

By

ANDREA MAE S. BALTAZAR

March 2024

Use the month and year of final defense (e.g. November 2024. For the hardbound, use the month and year of graduation (e.g. June 2025)





INTRODUCTION

Background of the Study

In writing your thesis proposal, you must follow the prescribed format of the Department. This document will help you format your document for submission. Generally, the document must be in A4 size, with 1.00-inch margins from top, right, and bottom; while 1.5 inches in the left. The left size has wider margin for binding purposes. The font “Georgia” must be used all throughout the document. Double spacing starting from “Introduction” must be observed.





Literature review is also included under this part. You may organize your literature review chronologically (by date of publication), thematically, or methodological (what methods had been used over time if the study will explore a new methodology). Reviews can also be from broad-to-specific topics, or by prominent authors of the field. A literature review is not a summary of your references. Present the reference’s objective, their methodology, and the result of the paper. Then, at the end of each theme, provide a synthesis and draw the connection from the reviews with the investigation,

The title page

The title page presents the title of your thesis. The word “proposal” must be included in the line “A Thesis” since the submitted document is yet to be proposed. This will only be removed during the final defense of the student. After the student’s name, the month and year of proposal defense must be reflected. Only the thesis title and name of the author are in bold face. As for font sizes, the title must be size 14, bold



face, centered. Meanwhile, the rest of the text in the title page is size 12, centered, in regular face (except for the name).

The introduction

The BAELS Thesis is divided into six (6) main parts: Introduction, Methodology, Results, Analysis, and Discussion, Conclusions and Recommendations, References, and Appendices. During the proposal defense, only the first two (Introduction and Methodology) are submitted together with the References.

The introduction part consists of the following: Background of the Study (with literature review), Direction of the Study (may be implicitly included as the last paragraph), Statement of the Problem, Research Framework, Significance of the Study, Scope and Limitations, and Definition of Terms.

Formatting

Section headers such as Introduction, Methodology, Results, Analysis, and Discussion, and Conclusions and Recommendations are centered, ALL CAPS, bold face, and in size 14. Page numbers in a new section header must be invisible.

Heading 1, or the sub-sections such as Background of the Study, Direction of the Study, Research Questions, Research Framework, Research Design, Research Process, etc., are left justified, size 12, bold face, in ALL CAPS.

Heading 2, or the parts under the sub-section (the literature review under the Background of the Study) is left justified, size 11, bold, and in sentence case. This literature review part may be organized by theme, or historically, from general to specific or vice versa. The literature review must provide support or counter your very own investigation. This will provide the readers an idea of what has been done from the past to establish the purpose and objective of the thesis.

The body or the content of the whole thesis is in Georgia, size 11. Table 1 summarizes these formatting requirements:

Table 1

Style descriptions

Description	Example
HEADING *Centered, all caps, size 14*	**INTRODUCTION** **METHODOLOGY** **RESULTS, ANALYSIS, AND DISCUSSION** **CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**
Sub-Heading 1 *Right alignment, sentence case, bold, size 12*	**Background of the Study** **Statement of the Problem** **Research Context** **Profile of the Respondents** **Conclusions**
Sub-Heading 2 Right alignment, sentence case, italics, size 12	*Literature Review Topics*
Sub-Heading 3 Indented first line, terminology in bold, (and/or period) after the term.	**[Significance of the Study]** **ELS Practitioners.** The significant benefit to this group must be explained. **[Definition of Terms]** **Terminology** may be defined conceptually and/or conceptually.
Body/Content Justified and indented, size 11	The body/content of the thesis must be justified throughout the document. Indentions must be observed.

Statement of the Problem

An explanation of the research gap may be included here. This part also ends by revealing the general objective or general research question that will guide the author in determining what information to gather afterwards.

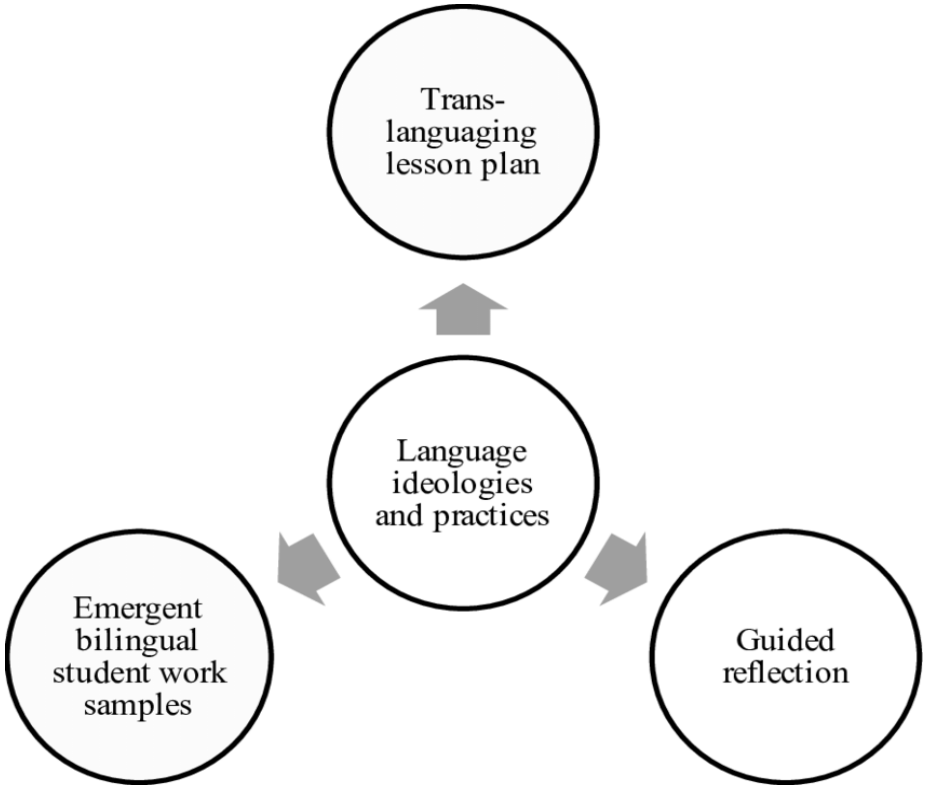
Specific research questions follow. There is not limit as to how much research questions, but three questions may be forwarded if these will encompass an in-depth investigation.

Research Framework

There are two ways of presenting your research framework - theoretical or conceptual. If the investigation is founded on a theory (e.g. Unequal Englishes by Tupas, 2015), it must be thoroughly discussed and how it will guide the current investigation. A theoretical framework is based on existing theories, models, and frameworks that provides a foundation of core knowledge. Meanwhile, a conceptual framework typically requires a visual representation of the expected relationships and connections. This is highly based on aspects drawn from theories and relationships of the variables of the study must be discussed. Figures 1 and 2 provide different conceptual frameworks.

Figure 1

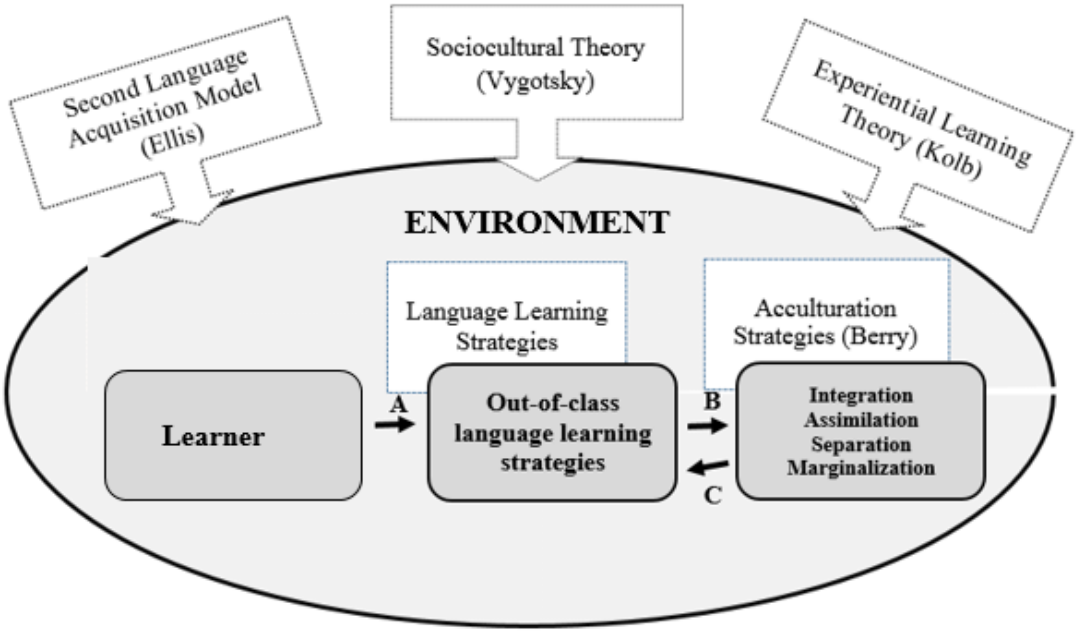
Simple Conceptual Framework



A discussion of the relationship of the variables must be provided afterwards.

Figure 2

A Conceptual Framework with several variables



A discussion of the relationship of the variables must be provided afterwards.

Skip one line for every new sub-section

Significance of the Study

An introductory statement of who will generally benefit your study. When specifying groups, follow the format:

Group 1. The results of the study…

Group 2. This group….

Scope and Limitations

Discuss what is the coverage of your thesis. What variables will be collected, and the reason/s for using them.

Definition of Terms

An introductory statement of who will generally benefit your study. When specifying groups, follow the format:

Term 1 is defined operationally and/or conceptually.

Term 2 is defined operationally and/or conceptually.

METHODOLOGY

A short introduction about the contents of this new section is recommended. You may discuss what each sub-section contains or how this new section is presented. As a new section, the page number is invisible and allow 4 single spaces from the top margin.

Skip one line for every new sub-section

Research Context

The research context must be described and discussed here. This part discusses the reasons for pursuing the thesis at hand (e.g. a particular linguistic family, source of diverse languages, issues with language and society, etc.).

Skip one line for every new sub-section

Research Design

The research design describes if the study is qualitative, quantitative, case study, experimental, or a mixed. If there is a standardized questionnaire used, discuss here the origin of the instrument and the scoring guide. If it is adapted, discuss what is included and the reason for excluding the remaining parts of the standardized questionnaire.

Research Process

This sub-section must present in detail the process that the thesis will undergo in achieving its goal. It may be discussed in paragraph form or outlined using small letters (a. Requesting Permission, b. Actual Data Gathering, c. Pilot Testing, etc.). For a thesis proposal, discuss the process of how the data will be gathered and analyzed.

Research Participants or Corpus

This sub-section is either about the research participants or the research corpus of the study. If the current investigation requires participants, then they must be described here - age, gender, race, and other reasons as to why they were targeted as participants.

If the research utilizes a corpus, describe here the kind of corpus the research will utilize. At times, they are directly attached in this sub-part. A criteria for selecting/determining the corpus - if the text has Filipino words, how many percent is acceptable for it to be included; the language used must be in English, etc.

Both (participants and corpus) may be utilized and thoroughly described in this sub-section.

Sections beyond this point are required only during Final Defense

RESULTS, ANALYSIS, AND DISCUSSION

This section presents the results and analysis from the gathered data and is arranged into _____ parts: *(the organization of this section will depend on the number of approved research questions)* Part 1 displays _____; part II showcases the _____; and part III presents _____.

I. Create a title related to research question 1

When presenting a quantitative data, a tabular presentation may be used. When reporting the results of your study, use the PAST TENSE of the verb (e.g. Results showed that…). Table numbers must be in chronological order and avoid the use of 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, or 1.a, 1.b., 1.c., etc., to avoid confusion. A brief table title must be included after the table title. There must always be a call out sentence for the immediate table to be presented. Table 1 presents the sample format of the BAELS prescribed table format. The table called out must be sandwiched between the call out statement and the analysis and the discussion follows the table.

Table 1

Profile of the Respondents

Respondent	Age	Educational Background	Years of Stay
A	20	Earned PhD units MA ELT BAELS PhD ELS	8
B	30	MAED BSEd English	13

The top and bottom border lines of the table have 2 ¼ pts. The only inside line found at the header part is ¼ pt. This can be found in the Table Design ribbon> ¼ pt and select 2 ¼ pt. The spacing inside the table may be 1.0 or single space to maximize the table and avoid splitting. If the data inside the table is numerical, center align the data. However, if the data in the table is narrative in nature (typically for research with transcriptions from interview), and the transcriptions must follow a hanging indention (see Table 2). Non-English words, phrases, or sentences may be translated right after them. Table 2 was taken from APA Style under the sample qualitative table with variable descriptions.

The discussion of the table previously presented may be supported by literature of having similar or even opposing results. When writing discussions, further narratives from the interview transcripts, or observations may also be included.

When the table is wider or longer than the page, either place it in landscape or cut the table. When cutting the table, repeat the header rows and write "Table # continued.

Table 2

Master Narrative Voices: Struggle and Success and Emancipation

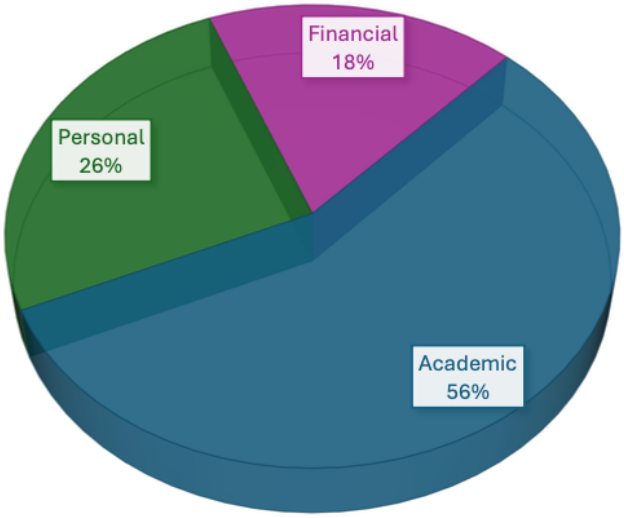
Discourse and Dimension	Example quote
Struggle and success Self-actualization as member of a larger gay community is the end goal of healthy sexual identity development, or "coming out"	"My path of gayness… going from denial to saying, well this is it, and then the process of coming out, and the process of just sort of, looking around and seeing, well where do I stand in the world, and sort of having, uh, political feelings." (Carl, age 50)

When a manuscript needs to present an image, use "Figure" with the same format as a table. The figure numbers must be in chronological order of their appearance in the whole manuscript. Figure 3 presents an example of a figure taken from the BAELS Exit Survey.

Since the figure number, title, and the figure itself does not fit in the space below, the figure was placed in the next page. If text appears in the image of the figure (e.g. axis labels, legends, notes), use sans serif font (Arial, Calibri, Helvetica, etc.) between 8 and 14 points (as prescribed by APA).

Figure 3

Reasons for BAELS students' Exit



When discussing implications of the results, use the present tense (e.g. The results indicate that …).

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

On this section, never repeat what has been presented from the previous section. Use the present tense of the verb in writing your conclusions, while recommendations may be written in the future tense.

Before providing your conclusions and recommendations, write a summary about your research – the research gap that you attempted to answer, your research questions in statement form, the framework you utilized, and the methodology.

Conclusions

In narrative form, discuss in this part the inferences, key takeaways, implications, interpretation, or the generalizations that you wish to highlight. Keep in mind that this part must directly answer both your general and specific research questions. Do not reiterate what has been said from the previous section. Answer directly the research gap that you identified at the beginning of the study.

Below is a sample conclusion written by Chan (2024) from her thesis entitled "Paradigmatic analysis of linguistic complexity in Philippine English News". Take note that this was written in Georgia, and in "normal" typeface.

***

As an official language of the Philippines, English has proven its status as an accessible language observably in how participants (n=24) rated themselves highly above average in terms of their proficiency in the English language. However, comprehensibility of the words heavily matters. One complex word could be highly

misinterpreted, making the audience ill-informed, fostering misinformation. Complex words were found necessary for 'impact' and for the knowledge they uniquely encapsulate, but in cases such as the use of the word "sans" when its common equivalent "without" is available, readers unavoidably labeled the writer in-charge as "gaudy". Numerous samples of the sans-situation led participants to think that such complexities are too unnecessary. Still, notwithstanding those findings, the use of complexities remains to be perceived as a display of "intelligence", together with the status of English in the Philippines as the language regarded as "for the educated" audiences. The findings of this study reveal that Filipino audiences do not immerse themselves in the English language, or in Philippine English-language news in this study's context, at least not enough to be familiarized with its jargon and style of writing despite claiming and proving that they are proficient in the language.

***

Recommendations

The statements under this part must be written to solve a concern from the study. These should also be logical and valid – do not recommend an idea or concept that is not related to the study. A recommendation for further study of the same topic may be included to amplify, verify, negate, and/or add/remove variables or parts of the framework that was not utilized. Keep your recommendations *realistic*, *practical*, and *attainable*.

REFERENCES

The reference section of the BAELS Thesis Manuscript shall follow the most recent American Psychological Association (APA) style of citation. The reference list shall be in alphabetical order. Generally, the following are the basic information included in each reference:

1. Author(s) name(s) in the order they appear in the source.
2. Publication year
3. Title of the source
4. Title of the book/journal/website the source comes from
5. Volume and issue number (journals, magazines, and newspapers)
6. Page numbers (except some online sources)
7. DOI number or URL for a website resource

When a work has a DOI, the DOI should always be used instead of a URL. For longer or complex DOI/URL, you may use shortDOI service (http://shortdoi.org) or bit.ly to shorten URLs. When creating such, make sure that the shortened URL is working and directs the reader to the article when clicked.

*Sample entries for **books**. Observe that the book titles are in italics.*

Gall, M. D., Borg, W. R., & Gall, J. P. (1996). *Education research: An introduction* (6th ed.). White Plains, NY: Longman

Iida, P., Ruegg, R., de Boer, M., Araki, N., & Agnello, M.F. (2020). *The Concise APA Handbook: APA 7th Edition*. Information Age Publishing, Inc. Charlotte, NC

*Sample entry for a **journal**. The journal name and volume number must be in italics.*

Kinasih, T.A., Yannuar, N., & Subiyanto, A. (2022). Discriminatory Discursive Strategies in Online Comments of a Vice Indonesia YouTube Video. *JoLLA: Journal of Language, Literature, and Arts, 2*(6), 865-879. Doi: 10.17977/um064v2i62022p865-879

If the screenshot is from **Instagram**, the reference entry shall be:

Gretchen “Gertie” Hirch [@gertie18]. (2021, February 17). This is such a cute #charmscoutcapelet from @ms.carnivale! This capelet pattern is our latest project on Patreon. You can also [Photograph]. Instagram. https://www.instagram.com/p/CLE53D0BWLr/

If the material is from **TikTok**, the reference entry shall be:

Author, A. A. [@username]. (Year, Month Day). *First 20 words of caption or description*[Video]. TikTok. URL

Example:

IndigenousLibrarian. [@indigenouslibrarian]. (2021, September 26). Lorisia McLeod's templates for citing Indigenous elders and knowledge keepers (2021) #greenscreensticker [Video]. TikTok. https://www.tiktok.com/@indigenouslibrarian/video/7012486813788933382

APPENDICES

Appendices are the supporting documents of the investigation. These may be the corpus of the study, request letters, transcriptions, and other documents that need not to be in the main body of the thesis but provide additional evidence.

The Appendix (if only one evidence) may be provided during the proposal defense so that the panel of experts can scrutinize the legitimacy of such. If you are presenting the results of your study during a final defense, appendices may be provided.